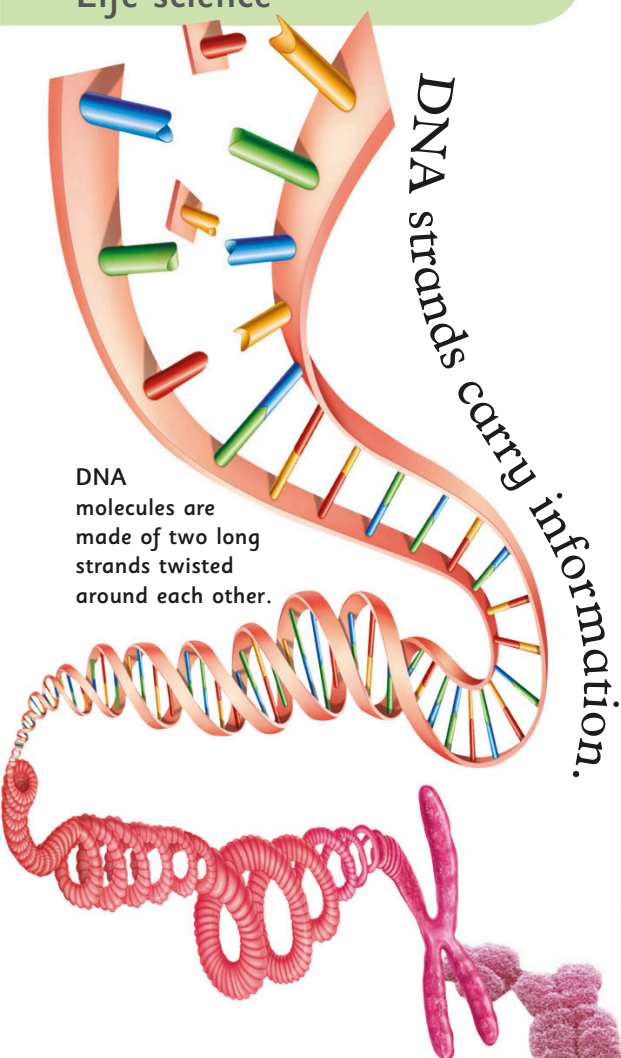


Inheritance

Your genes are a set of chemical instructions for building someone just like you. You inherit them from your parents, which is why you are like them in many ways. But unless you are a twin, your genes are unique.

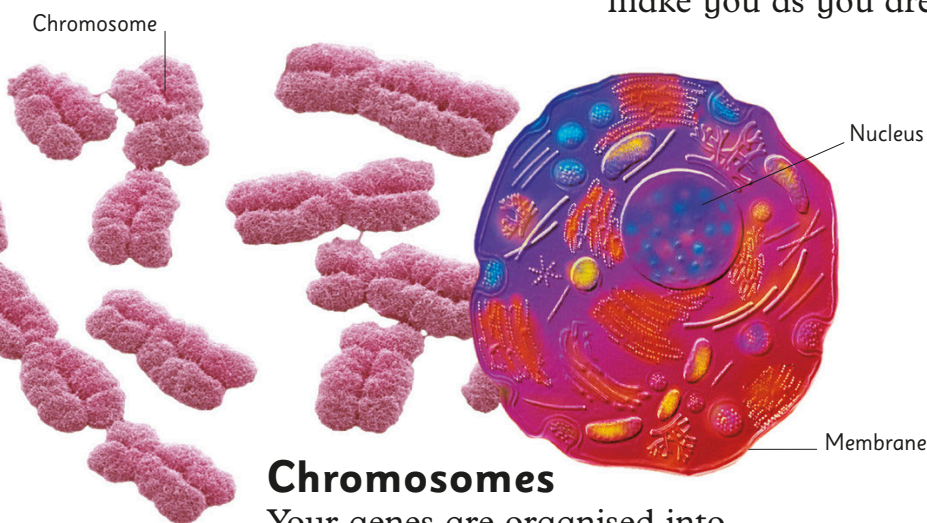
Tiny cells

Cells are the building blocks that make up all living things. Each cell in your body contains a complete set of genes—the information to make you as you are.



Amazing DNA

DNA is made of long molecules. Each molecule is made up of two parts joined together like a twisted rope ladder. DNA carries instructions on how to make cells work, and how different types of cells develop and join together to build a living thing, such as a plant or animal.



Chromosomes

Your genes are organised into 46 chromosomes, arranged in 23 pairs. Genes and chromosomes are made from the chemical called DNA.

What is a gene?

Every cell in your body contains a set of about 20,000 genes. All living things pass on their genes to their offspring. Sexual reproduction combines two sets



You can only roll your tongue if the right genes are active.

of genes. You've got two of each gene, one from your mother and one from your father. Sometimes the gene from your mother comes into action, and other times your father's gene wins out.